WEEKLY TRENDS
FOR SPC GLOBAL
ISSUE 1

WHAT ARE WE SEEING AROUND THE WORLD THIS WEEK?

Coconut water just got serious.

Alli & Kahn
Eclectic innovation team

Vita Coco bought Copra for up to US$275m and lifted its guidance after a 28% jump in Q2 sales. The category leader is speeding up, not slowing down. Protein kept turning up everywhere: in milk, in yoghurt pouches at Woolworths and in clear waters. Gut health is moving into the core range too, with Coca-Cola now piloting prebiotic fibre in Coke Zero.

Week of 12–18 October 2026

85 SIGNALS TRACKED
9 MARKETS
15 PACK & DESIGN IDEAS

Act on this now

COCONUT WATER · GLOBAL

Vita Coco buys Thai super-premium maker Copra for up to US$275m

Copra is a cold-chain coconut water producer with a 48% annual growth rate and a strong private-label business. Vita Coco pays US$175m upfront plus up to US$100m in earn-out.

Why it matters: The leader is moving into super-premium, chilled coconut water and building private-label muscle. That raises the bar for Casa Coco's positioning and sourcing story.

Food Business MEA · Read the story

DAIRY DRINKS · AUSTRALIA

Chobani sets its sights on Australia's billion-dollar milk drinks market

Chobani is pushing further into flavoured and high-protein milk in Australia, starting with a protein milk launch.

Why it matters: A well-funded global challenger is going straight after the shelf that SPC and Apta compete on.

Marketing Interactive · Read the story

REGULATION · UK

UK sugar levy extends to milk drinks, RTD coffee and kefir

The threshold drops to 4.5g sugar per 100ml and now covers flavoured milks, yoghurt drinks, RTD coffee and probiotic drinks, with a lactose allowance. Manufacturers have until 1 January 2028.

Why it matters: Any dairy shot, RTD coffee or kefir planned for UK export needs its recipe built to the new limit now.

DairyReporter · Read the story

Beverages & coconut water

COCONUT WATER · ESM MAGAZINE

Vita Coco raises FY26 guidance after Q2 sales jump 28%

The coconut water leader is accelerating.

Why it matters: Proof the category Casa Coco plays in is still growing fast.

ESM Magazine · Read the story

GUT HEALTH · GURUFOCUS

Coca-Cola pilots prebiotic fibre in Coke Zero, Sprite Zero and Fresca

6g of prebiotic fibre per serve, trialled in New York, New Jersey and Pennsylvania from late October.

Why it matters: The biggest soft drink maker is putting gut health inside its core zero-sugar range, not in a side brand.

GuruFocus · Read the story

PROTEIN WATER · PEPSICO

PepsiCo launches Propel Clear Protein with 20g protein

Clear flavoured protein water with fibre and electrolytes, sold as hydration rather than a shake.

Why it matters: Protein water is now a fight between the majors, not just challengers.

PepsiCo · Read the story

SHOTS · NOMBASE

UK functional shots pass £100m as growth speeds up

The UK wellness shots category has reached around £100m in value.

Why it matters: A useful benchmark for where the ANZ shots category could go.

Nombase · Read the story

Protein, dairy & yoghurt

YOGHURT · FOOD & DRINK BUSINESS

Muscle Nation launches protein yoghurt pouches, exclusive to Woolworths

150g pouches, 15g protein, no added sugar, $3 RRP, in 10 flavours.

Why it matters: A fitness brand is crossing into the dairy aisle on the back of a retailer exclusive.

Food & Drink Business · Read the story

YOGHURT · FOOD & DRINK BUSINESS

Danone takes its YoPro protein yoghurt into New Zealand

A new launch backed by brand ambassadors.

Why it matters: A global major is expanding protein dairy across ANZ.

Food & Drink Business · Read the story

METABOLIC HEALTH · FOODNAVIGATOR

Mengniu links its LC19 probiotic to GLP-1 in dairy

China's dairy giant is rolling its own probiotic strain into products, with a documentary on its role in GLP-1.

Why it matters: An early template for how GLP-1 language could reach mainstream dairy.

FoodNavigator · Read the story

Retail & rules

AUSTRALIA · ABC NEWS

Coles and Woolworths centralise supply chains

Both are buying through fewer, larger suppliers. Coles cut its distribution centres from 23 to 18 since 2019 and added 1,600 own-brand products last year.

Why it matters: Supplier power is shrinking and own brand is growing. Go into every range review with a plan.

ABC News · Read the story

MIDDLE EAST · WORLDPANEL BY NUMERATOR

UAE's tiered sugar tax is reshaping Gulf drinks pricing

Sugar-based tax tiers are now changing shelf prices and pushing reformulation.

Why it matters: A live case study in sugar-tax economics for any export plans.

Worldpanel by Numerator · Read the story

Pay homage to: pack & design

DIELINE AWARDS · THE DIELINE

Schweppes and PAZ take the 2026 beverage awards

Schweppes won Soft Drinks by evolving its identity rather than reinventing it. PAZ won Functional Beverage with restrained, 80s running-inspired graphics.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to the Schweppes approach when refreshing an established SPC brand: keep the equity, sharpen everything around it.

The Dieline · Read the story

FRUIT DRINKS · THE DIELINE

Wildling Schorle goes big and bold

An oversized orange 'splash' graphic and an unruly wordmark, breaking from the usual apple-and-leaf style.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to its confidence on fruit-led drinks: one huge graphic idea beats a busy fruit illustration on a crowded shelf.

The Dieline · Read the story

PINTEREST · B&T

Pinterest names its 2026 colours: Wasabi, Persimmon, Plum Noir

Based on two years of search and save data. Plum Noir saves are up 335%.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to Wasabi or Persimmon as a shelf-standout colour for a better-for-you drinks range.

B&T · Read the story

Opportunity of the week

7
/10

Glow Coconut Water: beauty from the fridge

$4.50 · 330ml

Coconut water with marine collagen and vitamin C, still or lightly sparkling. Strawberry Blossom, Yuzu, Watermelon Rose. For women 25–45 who buy collagen powder but would rather drink it.

Whole Foods has named 'Beautrition' a 2027 trend, and almost nothing like it sits in Australian grocery. It adds a high-margin SKU to coconut water without adding another plain one.

Pack idea: A pearlescent, skincare-style pack that looks like it belongs in the bathroom cabinet.

DEMAND	7
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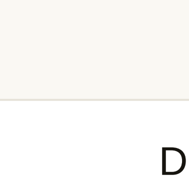

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Do the homework, then commit and go hard.

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